EMOTION REGULATION SESSION 3

Build Mastery and Cope Ahead
PLEASE Skills

Build Mastery and Cope Ahead

Build Mastery

1. Plan on doing at least one thing each day to build a sense of accomplishment.
   Example: _____

2. Plan for success, not failure.
   - Do something difficult, but possible.

3. Gradually increase the difficulty over time.
   - If the first task is too difficult, do something a little easier next time.

4. Look for a challenge.
   - If the task is too *easy*, try something a little harder next time.

Cope Ahead of Time with Difficult Situations

1. **Describe** the situation that is likely to prompt problem behavior.
   - Check the facts. Be specific in describing the situation.
   - Name the emotions and actions likely to interfere with using your skills.

2. **Decide** what coping or problem-solving skills you want to use in the situation.
   - Be specific. Write out in detail how you will cope with the situation and with your emotions and action urges.

3. **Imagine the situation** in your mind as vividly as possible.
   - Imagine yourself IN the situation NOW, not watching the situation.

4. **Rehearse in your mind coping effectively.**
   - Rehearse in your mind exactly what you can do to cope effectively.
   - Rehearse your actions, your thoughts, what you say, and how to say it.
   - Rehearse coping effectively with new problems that come up.
   - Rehearse coping effectively with your most feared catastrophe.

5. **Practice relaxation *after* rehearsing.**

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Taking Care of Your Mind by Taking Care of Your Body

Remember these as **PLEASE** skills.

P
L

1. Treat PhysicaL Illness. Take care of your body. See a doctor when necessary. Take prescribed medication.

E

2. Balance Eating. Don't eat too much or too little. Eat regularly and mindfully throughout the day. Stay away from foods that make you feel overly emotional.

A

3. Avoid Mood-Altering Substances. Stay off illicit drugs, and use alcohol in moderation (if at all).

S

4. Balance Sleep. Try to get 7–9 hours of sleep a night, or at least the amount of sleep that helps you feel good. Keep to a consistent sleep schedule, especially if you are having difficulty sleeping.

E

5. Get Exercise. Do some sort of exercise every day. Try to build up to 20 minutes of daily exercise.

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Steps for Reducing Vulnerability to Emotion Mind

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

For each emotion regulation skill, note whether you used it during the week, and describe what you did.

B

MINDFULNESS OF POSITIVE EXPERIENCES WHEN THEY OCCURRED

Focused (and refocused) attention on positive experiences: _____

Distracted from worries if they showed up: _____

BUILD MASTERY

Scheduled activities to build a sense of accomplishment (circle): M T W Th F S Sun

Describe: _____

_____

Actually did something difficult, **BUT** possible (circle): M T W Th F S Sun

Describe: _____

_____

C

COPE AHEAD

Describe a situation that prompts unwanted emotions (fill out Steps 1 and 2 of checking the facts on Emotion Regulation Worksheet 5 if necessary):

_____

_____

Way that I imagined coping effectively (describe):

_____

_____

Way that I imagined coping with new problems that might arise (describe):

_____

PLEASE

Skills

Have I . . .

Treated PhysicaL illness? _____

_____

Balanced Eating? _____

_____

Avoided mood-Altering substances? _____

_____

Balanced Sleep? _____

_____

Exercised? _____

_____